been a wholesale rush towards Westernization, he complained. Chinese children wanted to learn how to play the violin and the piano, not the pipa or the qin; Chinese women wanted to wear Western skirts, not the traditional qipao.

On India's economic prospects, however, he conveyed scepticism because of its bewildering diversity and lack of community spirit. Even in these observations, politely conveyed, we see echoes of the earlier Chinese perceptions and critiques of India.

Post the clashes in eastern Ladakh in 2020, we again notice a relapse into abusive language. One recent article calls Indians 'big-time thieves'. [13] The author goes on to make blatantly racist comments:

> While talking their gestures such as shaking of head, gesticulating, touching mouth, shaking eyebrows, making signs etc and so on, however without harmful intentions these are no doubt unnerving. [14]

The same article makes a strange and utterly false claim concerning the 1962 border talks:

> During the early negotiations in 1962, the Indian side even proposed Tibet belonged to India, that Sichuan province be declared a demilitarized zone and last but not the least they even demanded the Indian Army be permitted to be stationed at Chengdu in order to monitor the implementation of the demilitarized zone. The Chinese representatives were stunned. [15]

Indeed, so are the Indians!

We see that a line runs through the negative and derogatory perceptions of India and Indians in China, which took hold during the British colonial period. While India's past glory as a great civilization was conceded, in contemporary times it became an example of a failed and fallen country. The reason for this decline was said to be the slavish character of its people and the lack of a strong central political authority to mobilize the people to resist foreign aggression. The Chinese depictions of Indians bordered on being racist. These impressions were also derived by translations into Chinese or Japanese of writings by British colonial authors who justified British colonial rule as a civilizational mission of redeeming a race which had lost any civilizational attributes it may once have had and lacked any ethics or scruples. India was thus held up as a teacher by negative example.

India's present, then, was the future that would await China if it did not